LOAN ADVISOR GROUP
mortgage solutions

First-Time Homebuyer Guide

COLORADO MORTGAGE
& DOWN PAYMENT
ASSISTANCE OPTIONS

Your first home may be closer than you think.



understand your options

FOUR PATHS TO HOMEOWNERSHIP

Low-down-payment financing and Colorado assistance can work together, depending on eligibility.

01 CONVENTIONAL FIRST-TIME BUYER

FROM 3% DOWN*

BEST FOR	Eligible buyers with stable income and an interest in conventional financing.
HOW IT WORKS	Certain conventional programs permit a 3% down payment on a primary residence. Mortgage insurance usually applies below 20% down.
WHAT TO PREPARE	Income documentation, recent bank statements, credit information and down-payment funds.
OUR ADVICE	Compare the total monthly payment, including mortgage insurance, rather than the down payment alone.

02 FHA HOME LOAN

FROM 3.5% DOWN*

BEST FOR	Buyers who may benefit from FHA credit and underwriting flexibility.
HOW IT WORKS	FHA-insured mortgages can permit a 3.5% down payment for qualifying borrowers. FHA mortgage insurance and property requirements apply.
WHAT TO PREPARE	Income and employment records, bank statements, identification and debt information.
OUR ADVICE	Ask us to compare FHA and conventional payments side by side before choosing.

*Starting down payments are illustrative. Eligibility, credit, occupancy, mortgage insurance, lender requirements and costs vary.

explore colorado assistance

HELP WITH UPFRONT COSTS

Two notable Colorado programs that may help eligible buyers with down payment or closing costs.

03 CHFA DOWN PAYMENT ASSISTANCE

GRANT OR DEFERRED SECOND MORTGAGE*

BEST FOR	Colorado buyers who qualify for a participating CHFA first mortgage.
HOW IT WORKS	CHFA lists a grant up to the lesser of $25,000 or 3% of the first mortgage, or a deferred second mortgage up to the lesser of $25,000 or 4%. These are alternatives, not combined benefits.
WHAT TO PREPARE	Income and credit information, borrower contribution and homebuyer education as required.
OUR ADVICE	A grant and a second mortgage have different costs and repayment rules. Compare both with the first-mortgage rate.

04 METRODPA

ASSISTANCE THROUGH A SECOND MORTGAGE*

BEST FOR	Eligible Front Range buyers who want help with initial cash needs.
HOW IT WORKS	MetroDPA pairs eligible first mortgages with assistance that varies by loan product and market conditions. Its deferred second-mortgage option has 0% interest and no monthly payments, with repayment triggers.
WHAT TO PREPARE	Income and employment documentation, credit information and an eligible property.
OUR ADVICE	Check assistance amount, income limit, first-mortgage pricing and when the second mortgage becomes due.

*Assistance amounts, rates, limits, funding and eligibility can change. CHFA and metroDPA have distinct rules and are not automatically combinable.

choose your path

MORE OPTIONS TO EXPLORE

Specialized assistance, an example of upfront costs, and the documents that help you prepare.

CHFA SCHOOLS TO HOME

FOR ELIGIBLE FULL-TIME PUBLIC SCHOOL EMPLOYEES

CHFA describes a second mortgage for up to 25% of the first mortgage amount, with a shared-appreciation obligation. Repayment of the assistance and an appreciation share is deferred until a specified event. Education courses, employment verification, income and credit rules apply.

CHFA COLORADO CHAMPIONS

For eligible Colorado peace officers, firefighters, and EMTs. Assistance is up to the lesser of $25,000 or 4% of the first mortgage as a deferred second loan. Borrower income must be at or below $196,810; employment, credit and other program requirements apply. Launch: Nov 2026.

WHAT DOES 3% OR 3.5% DOWN LOOK LIKE?

HOME PRICE	3% DOWN	3.5% DOWN
$350,000	$10,500	$12,250
$400,000	$12,000	$14,000
$500,000	$15,000	$17,500

Down payment is only one part of cash to close. Plan for title and lender fees, appraisal, insurance, prepaid taxes, escrow deposits and any required reserves. Eligible seller concessions or assistance may offset some costs.

WHAT TO HAVE READY

Photo ID | Recent pay stubs or income records | Bank statements | Debt details | Employment history | Gift documentation, if applicable | Homebuyer education, if required

Programs are not necessarily available through every lender. Schools To Home includes equity sharing; ask for a full repayment illustration before proceeding.



your next chapter

LET'S MAKE A PLAN FOR YOUR FIRST HOME

You may have more options than you think.

A complimentary 15-minute first-time homebuyer review

SCHEDULE YOUR FREE REVIEW

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We can review your estimated monthly payment, available down-payment assistance, potential closing costs, and what to prepare before you start shopping.

Educational information only; not a commitment to lend. All loans subject to credit, income, property, underwriting and program approval. Assistance may require repayment, including shared appreciation. Availability, rates, limits and guidelines may change. Verify all disclosures with Loan Advisor Group before distribution.

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